

His tragic end leaves a family and the Congress orphaned. Serious questions arise over the cause of the crash and the political legacy he leaves.

| By Amarnath K. Menon |

He was the ultimate survivor, a politician who never missed an opportunity to maintain his rural connection, and it was that drive which ultimately proved fatal. A full 24 hours after the biggest search and secure operation in India, the remains of the Bell 430 chopper and the charred bodies of all five passengers were located. It had crashed in squally and wet weather, atop a hillock near Atmakur in Nallamala Hills in Kurnool district. The cause of the crash and possibly serious aviation violations will only be known later but his tragic end leaves the state in shock.

Yedugiri Sandinti Rajasekhara Reddy was no ordinary chief minister. Dynamic, resourceful, a powerful enemy and a valuable ally, YSR, as he was popularly known, was a man of the people in every sense of the term. His sudden exit leaves not just a family orphaned but also the Congress party. It was his performance in the last Lok Sabha polls which proved decisive in the Congress returning to power at the Centre.

His death has left a huge void in a state that mattered most for the party. His shock exit comes less than four months after his second innings as chief minister. With his unwavering commitment to the development of the state and unflinching loyalty to the party, he ran what was virtually a one-man show. That he bagged for the party, 156 of the 294 Assembly seats and 33 of the 42 Lok Sabha seats in this

A PRABHAKARAO

# The Man of ACTION



YSR'S CHARISMA AND POLICIES  
WON HIM A LEGION OF ADMIRERS

**ANDHRA PRADESH HAS NOT SEEN HIS LIKE AS CHIEF MINISTER. DYNAMIC AND RESOURCEFUL, HE HAD AN UNERRING INSTINCT FOR THE PULSE OF THE VOTER.**